

INT. DINGY ROOM - NIGHT

EMMETT and JAKE sit on a couch playing Fortnite. FourLoko cans are on the table in front of them.

A pop up shows up on the screen.

JAKE
What the hell is this?

EMMETT
They're using AI to...make Fortnite better?

They let out a collective groan.

JAKE
It's a fucking video game what do they need AI for?

EMMETT
I really don't know.

JAKE
I don't even want to play anymore.
Why is nothing safe from AI
bullshit?

They toss their controllers aside.

JAKE (CONT'D)
What now?

EMMETT
Maybe it's Loko time.

Emmett looks towards the unopened FourLokos. Jake shrugs.

JAKE
Hey, it's not like either of us
have work tomorrow.

They reach for the drinks.

CUT TO:

INT. DINGY ROOM - MORNING

A phone is buzzing. Jake's eyes open against his will. He groans and looks over at his phone. It's an unknown number. He's puzzled, but answers it anyways.

JAKE
Hello?

IVAN
Yes, is this Jake?

JAKE
Uh, yeah, who's this?

IVAN
This is Ivan. I'm just calling to confirm your scheduled interview later today?

JAKE
Interview?

IVAN
Well, yes, you didn't think we'd just hand you the positions did you?

JAKE
Uh, no. Of course not. What time was it again?

IVAN
Two pm. And Emmett will be in attendance as well?

Jake looks over at Emmett. Emmett, just woken up, looks back perplexed.

JAKE
Uh, yeah. He'll be there.

IVAN
Ok. I look forward to meeting both of you!

Ivan hangs up.

EMMETT
Who was that?

JAKE
I don't know but I think he wants to give us jobs. We have an interview at two.

EMMETT
Oh god really? How much FourLoko did we drink last night?

He looks over at his laptop and turns it on. LinkedIn is pulled.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

I guess we applied to this...thing.

JAKE

What is it?

EMMETT

I don't really know. Some AI data company thing.

JAKE

We're not qualified for that. What does it say the qualifications are?

EMMETT

It doesn't say.

JAKE

I don't want to do some AI bullshit man.

EMMETT

Yeah me either.

He looks around him at the trash and filth of their one room apartment.

JAKE

Wait, how much does it pay?

EMMETT

Eighty-thousand dollars a year.

They both go silent. Then suddenly they're in a frenzy, tossing on fresh clothes and brushing their teeth and so on.

EXT. STREET - DAY

Emmett and Jake bike to the job interview.

INT. AI OFFICE - DAY

Emmett and Jake sit behind a desk. In front of them is IVAN. Behind him is a CLTDM slideshow.

IVAN

So, what's your dream job?

EMMETT

Well It's always been my dream to have a job, sir.

IVAN

Uh, sure. And you?

JAKE

Uh, I've always wanted to change the world. And this seems like just the place to do that.

IVAN

You're just going to be doing some basic server maintenance. You know that right?

JAKE

Uh, yeah. I know that. Server maintenance has just always interested me in it's potential to uh...maintain.

IVAN

Well, I'm glad to hear that. Here at CLTDM we're taking a new approach to AI and it's role in many things in the public sphere. From parks and buses to benches and bike lanes, we believe that AI can make everything better. We're also working on developing revolutionary AI-powered kitchen appliances and shoes!

He points to a picture on a slideshow of the worst buses, kitchen appliances, benches, and shoes you've ever seen. Emmett and Jake look at each other.

IVAN (CONT'D)

We've developed a highly advanced Artificial Intelligence called ALIGN that is more powerful and advanced than any of our competitor's. Our current project is a mass reconsideration of the bike lanes in the surrounding area.

Ivan changes the slide to show a bike lane diagram.

IVAN (CONT'D)

ALIGN is helping us to build the safest and most efficient roads that we can.

EMMETT

Wow, this is all very impressive,
sir!

Ivan smiles.

IVAN

Look, usually with these types of
positions, you're not supposed to
give them out on the spot. But I
think you two might be just what
this position calls for. So what do
you say?

JAKE

So we got the job?

IVAN

You got the job! You can start
tomorrow!

EXT. SIDEWALK - DAY

Jake is waiting on the sidewalk. Emmett pulls up in the
SmartCar, top down. He's eating Pad Thai and wearing
sunglasses and a visor.

JAKE

Oh no, what did you do?

EMMETT

Hey this thing moves! And it's
pennies to us now!

JAKE

I kind of liked biking to work. And
we haven't even worked a full day
yet. Are you sure this was a good
idea?

EMMETT

I got it with Klarna man. I'm never
gonna have to pay it back anyways.
C'mon, we're gonna be late.

Jake shakes his head but hops in the car and they speed away.

INT. OFFICE BUILDING - DAY

The elevator opens and Jake and Emmett step out. JOEY is
waiting for them.

JOEY
You must be Emmett and Jake!

JAKE
Yeah that's us. I'm Jake.

EMMETT
Emmett. Nice to meet you.

They shake hands.

JOEY
I'm Joey. I'm also on the ALIGN team. Ivan said I'm in charge of giving you the rundown this morning.

They walk into a room of desks. Joey points at two.

JOEY (CONT'D)
This is where you'll be working.

Emmett and Jake sit down at their respective desks, and Joey helps them get logged on.

JOEY (CONT'D)
So basically what you're going to be doing is this.

On Emmett's screen is a captcha that says "click all squares with bicycles". Joey clicks the bikes. The computer makes a ding sound, and a new captcha appears.

JOEY (CONT'D)
Just click all the bicycles. Here, give it a try.

Emmett successfully clicks all the bikes.

EMMETT
That's it?

JOEY
That's it. Not a bad gig, right?

EMMETT
No, not at all.

He smiles and leans back in his chair.

INT. OFFICE BUILDING - DAY

A few hours later. Emmett and Jake are hard at work on their captchas.

EMMETT

I'm gonna run to the kitchen, you want anything?

JAKE

No thanks.

Emmett stands up and heads to the kitchen. On his return he notices some stuff on Joey's desk. It's a picture of Joey dunking, and a picture of Joey hoisting a trophy.

EMMETT

You a big basketball guy?

JOEY

I was. But that was all before...

FLASHBACK TO:

INT. BASKETBALL COURT

Joey is dunking on guys and hitting step backs left right and center. He's unstoppable.

After the game, Joey is conversing with an NBA SCOUT.

SCOUT

Just keep your head on your shoulders and you should go top twenty. I don't see you falling any farther than that.

JOEY (V.O.)

It was all going so well, until one day I felt a pain in my shoulder during a game...

Joey is playing basketball, but suddenly stops dribbling, clutching at his shoulder.

JOEY (V.O.)

The doctor said my shoulder was at risk of a sever dislocation as a result of playing on the monkey bars too much as a child, but that I would be fine and able to keep playing basketball as long as I didn't dunk anymore.

Joey is playing basketball again.

JOEY

But I just couldn't help myself.
Dunking on guys brought me more joy
than anything in the world. I
couldn't help myself.

He violently dunks on a guy's head. As he hangs on the rim,
his shoulder comes out and he goes falling to the floor.

JOEY (V.O.)

The doctors said they'd never seen
anything like it. I dislodged my
shoulder so bad they had to hook it
up to an F-150 to pull it back in.
I could never play the same again.

INT. OFFICE BUILDING - DAY

JOEY

And now I work here.

EMMETT

I'm sorry man.

JAKE

Yeah, that sucks.

JOEY

Don't worry about it. This pays
well doesn't it? I'm not sure what
else I'd be doing with my life
anyways.

Also on Joey's desk is a small painting.

EMMETT

Did you paint that?

JOEY

Yeah, it's just something I do on
the side since I stopped playing
basketball.

Ivan comes into the room.

IVAN

C'mon now guys, back to work. This
AI isn't gonna generate itself!

Emmett heads back to his seat, taking one last look at the
picture of Joey dunking as he does so.

INT. SMART CAR - NIGHT

Emmett and Jake are heading home in the Smart Car.

EMMETT

If every day's that easy this job's
gonna be a blast.

JAKE

I can't believe that's all they
have us doing.

In front of them is a cyclist, EBEN.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

He whistles to himself as he bikes along. Suddenly, a car
pulls out in front of him, and he has to slam on his brakes
to avoid a collision.

Eben heads straight for the guy. The DRIVER waves
apologetically. Eben smiles and feigns forgiveness, but
motions for the driver to put down his window. The Driver
does.

DRIVER

I'm very sorry I just didn't-

Eben reaches through the open window and grabs the guy by the
shirt collar and draws a gun and points it at him.

INT. SMARTCAR - NIGHT

Emmett and Jake witness Eben draw the gun.

JAKE

Oh fuck. Let's get out of here.

The Driver speeds off. Eben turns and sees Emmett and Jake,
and starts running towards them.

EMMETT

Oh fuck oh fuck.

Emmett frantically tries to put the car in reverse, but it's
not working.

JAKE

What's wrong? Reverse out of here!

EMMETT

It won't go! I think it's because I
spilled all that Pad Thai in it
earlier.

The gear console is full of noodles.

JAKE

You what?

Suddenly, the sound of a gun cocking as a pistol is pressed
to the back of Emmett's head.

EBEN

Who are you two? Why are you
watching me?

Suddenly, he notices Emmett's work tag around his neck.

EBEN (CONT'D)

You guys work for CLTDM?

EMMETT

Yes but today was our first day.

EBEN

What department?

EMMETT

What?

EBEN

I said what department!?

He pushes the gun into Emmett's head.

EMMETT

ALIGN! We work in ALIGN.

Eben muses on this for a moment.

EBEN

Let me in.

EMMETT

What?

EBEN

I said let me in the car.

EMMETT

But there's only two seats?

INT. SMART CAR - NIGHT

Eben sits awkwardly in the trunk still holding the gun to Emmett's head.

EBEN
Slow down! Fucking driver scum.

Emmett and Jake look at each other.

EBEN (CONT'D)
I wasn't really going to kill that guy you know. I just think that drivers deserve to feel a minutia of the fear they make bikers feel on a daily fucking basis once in a while.

Emmett and Jake stay silent as they pull up to their house.

EBEN (CONT'D)
This is it?

Emmett nods.

EBEN (CONT'D)
Come on. Let's go up.

INT. DINGY ROOM - NIGHT

Eben sits on a couch facing Emmett and Jake, still holding the gun at them.

EBEN
Captchas!? They just have you doing Captchas all day?

JAKE
Yeah that was it.

Eben shakes his head.

EBEN
You, tie him up.

He motions from Emmett to Jake.

EMMETT
What?

EBEN
Tie him up. Use these.

He tosses Emmett some ropes.

EMMETT
I'm not going to-

Eben points the gun at him.

EMMETT (CONT'D)
Okay okay.

He ties Jake up to a chair.

Eben keeps the gun pointed at Jake.

EMMETT (CONT'D)
Why are you doing this?

EBEN
You're going to get something for
me, or he's going to die.

EMMETT
What? What do you want?

EBEN
You're going to go back to CLTDM,
log onto the main ALIGN computer
and plug this in.

He holds up a thumb drive.

EBEN (CONT'D)
This drive is coded with a process
to extract what I need. Once it
finishes downloading, bring it back
here and you'll never see me again.
You think you can handle that?

EMMETT
Yeah, I can handle that.

He takes the thumb drive.

EBEN
Do you two have any idea what CLTDM
actually does? Do you know what
you're actually working on in that
office?

JAKE
Uhh, like data...and stuff.

Eben shakes his head.

EBEN

You two have no fucking idea about anything. CLDTM is attempting to eliminate all bike lanes.

EMMETT

No, they're just trying to make them better.

EBEN

That's what they told you huh? Look.

He pulls out two maps of a town. He points to the first map.

EBEN (CONT'D)

This is a map of Cambridgetown, Wyoming before CLTDM moved in. More bike lanes than 95% of small cities in the US.

He points to the second map.

EBEN (CONT'D)

This is after five years of CLTDM. They're ALL gone. There isn't a bike lane left. And they're going to do the same thing here.

Emmett and Jake look at each other.

EBEN (CONT'D)

Look, you don't have to believe me. You just have to do it or he dies.

Emmett is just standing there.

EBEN (CONT'D)

Well get going. Bring back that drive with what I need and you guys can make it out of this in one piece.

EXT. OFFICE BUILDING - LATE NIGHT

Emmett looks around him as he scans his work ID and enters the building.

INT. OFFICE BUILDING - NIGHT

Emmett steps out of the elevator into the office.

He walks through the halls until he reaches an important looking computer.

He scans his ID again to enter the room.

He sits down at the computer and turns it on. Then he pulls out the thumb drive Eben gave them and plugs it into the computer.

It's immediately starts a downloading process. It's not going very fast.

Suddenly, footsteps can be heard approaching. Emmett swings around, panicked. The door swings open and in the door way is...Joey.

JOEY

Emmett? What are you doing here?

Emmett steps in front of the computer screen to hide it.

EMMETT

Just putting in some overtime. What are YOU doing?

JOEY

I always work late. It's...sort of all I've got going for me right now.

EMMETT

What about the painting?

JOEY

Yeah, I just don't have the time, you know?

Joey looks around.

JOEY (CONT'D)

Wait, but you don't work in this office. Why are you on the main computer?

EMMETT

Just taking care of some stuff Ivan wanted me to do.

Joey is suspicious. Somewhere else in the office, a different, louder noise sounds.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

What was that?

JOEY

I don't know. But what are you doing? I didn't hear anything about any special work on the main computer.

He approaches Emmett and the computer.

EMMETT

Oh, no, you wouldn't have been told about-

But he pushes Emmett aside and comes face to face with the download progress.

JOEY

You're...downloading the entire schematics? You're not allowed to do that!

EMMETT

Joey wait I can explain.

JOEY

It better be a damn good explanation.

EMMETT

What if I told you that CLTDM is not what you think it is? That it's getting rid of bike lanes, not making them better?

Joey hesitates.

JOEY

I already know.

EMMETT

Wait, all that's true? And you know about it and still work here?

JOEY

It pays well. It's only for a little while, just until I can figure something else out.

A loud bang is heard in the hallway outside.

EMMETT

Is someone else working late tonight?

JOEY

No, they're not supposed to be.

Loud footsteps approach the door.

JOEY (CONT'D)

Hello?

The door is flung open and in bursts an ALIEN. It lunges at Joey and grabs him. Emmett shoulder checks it off Joey, but it recovers quickly.

JOEY (CONT'D)

What the hell?

ALIEN

(screeches)

EMMETT

What the fuck is that?

JOEY

I don't know. I knew about the bike lanes but I've never seen this thing.

The Alien makes a move for the computer.

EMMETT

It's trying to stop the download!

Emmett tries to stop the Alien. He fails to halt it until he decides to pick up the desk chair and swing it, knocking the Alien back. The Alien charges Emmett, and starts beating him up. Emmett looks to Joey.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

Help!

JOEY

I'm sorry but I can't betray the company.

The Alien goes to choke Emmett, who grabs its wrist, barely holding it off.

EMMETT

Yes you can. It's never the wrong time to start living again. I know things have been hard and life hasn't gone how you wanted it to, but that doesn't mean you have to call it quits.

It knocks Emmett's arm aside, successfully choking him.
Emmett look to Joey.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

There's so much you still have to
offer the world. Like that painting
on your desk. You have so much
potential.

Emmett starts to fade. Joey's face contorts, and then
suddenly he grabs the chair and smacks it into the Alien,
causing it to drop Emmett, who gasps for air.

Joey winds back up and throws the chair at the alien, but his
shoulder gives out and he misses badly. Joey rushes him and
tackles it to the floor.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

Try-try to hold him off!

Joey grapples with the Alien. Emmett rushes back over to the
computer to check on the download. It's almost complete.

EMMETT (CONT'D)

C'mon, c'mon...

The computer makes a ding noise as it reaches 100%. Download
complete. Emmett removes the drive, puts it in his pocket and
then turns around.

The Alien goes to lunge at Emmett but Joey holds it off.

JOEY

Go on, get out of here. Take down
CLTDM.

EMMETT

Are you sure?

Joey nods.

The Alien breaks free from Joey and again lunges for Emmett
and the drive but Joey holds it back at the last moment with
his busted arm. The alien then turns back to attack Joey, and
Emmett leaves the room. Joey closes the door behind him.
Emmett runs down the hallway, the sounds of the scuffle
echoing in his ears. He brushes aside a tear.

EXT. PARKING LOT - NIGHT

Emmett jumps in and starts the Smart Car. The Alien bursts
out of the front of the office building. Emmett puts it in
drive and speeds off.

INT. DINGY ROOM - NIGHT

Emmett enters the room. Eben is waiting for him, gun still pointed at Jake.

EBEN
You got it?

Emmett hands it over.

EMMETT
Yeah.

JAKE
Oh thank god.

Eben snatches it from him and plugs it into his computer.

EMMETT
You didn't say anything about a
fucking alien!

EBEN
You mean Align?

EMMETT
No not Align, alien! An alien tried
to kill me when I tried to download
the schematics?

EBEN
Very funny.

EMMETT
I'm not joking!

Eben's eyes go wide.

EBEN
There was an actual alien in there?

EMMETT
Well it sure as hell wasn't a
normal ass guy!

EBEN
Fuck, this thing might go deeper
than I thought.

EMMETT
Yeah whatever. Can I untie him now?

He motions to Jake.

JAKE
Yeah can he untie me now?

EBEN
Yeah sure. I'm sending the kill
code back into the AI.

Emmett goes over and unties Jake.

JAKE
Kill code?

EBEN
It was written in by a rogue
engineer who knew what CLTDM was
trying to do. It's gonna make the
AI cannibalize itself.

JAKE
It's going to kill the AI? So we
won't have jobs? You didn't tell us
that!

EBEN
Well, it's not like you had a
choice. Besides, a lot of good
cyclists died to make this
possible.

EMMETT
And one great painter.

JAKE
What?

EMMETT
Joey...the Alien, it...it killed
him.

JAKE
No! He can't be-

BANG!

The wall bursts open in a cloud of drywall dust. Everyone
coughs as the air clears. Maniacal laughter fills the
silence.

Standing before them is Ivan. He points at Eben.

IVAN
It was so easy. The higher ups
didn't want to let me try it. They
thought it was too risky.
(MORE)

IVAN (CONT'D)

But I knew you wouldn't be able to resist trying to corrupt a couple of idiots, and that they would lead me right to you.

JAKE

What?

Eben recovers from the blast and his eyes narrow.

EBEN

You...

He whips a piece of drywall at Ivan, who catches it and turns it to dust in his grasp.

IVAN

I've been looking for you for a long time. You're the only one we didn't get when we slaughtered your whole operation.

EBEN

Don't worry. It only takes one to finish the job.

He spin kicks him, but Ivan is unaffected. He counter punches Eben, sending him flying.

IVAN

I'm running on pure AI, son. The newest update.

He turns to reveal a wire running from his brain into an AI computer device on his back.

JAKE

Eww.

EMMETT

What the hell?

Eben throws another object at Ivan but he dodges it effortlessly.

IVAN

Your whole movement is pointless. AI will make the world better than it ever could be with just humans at the helm. My extraterrestrial friends have shown me.

He throws a punch at Eben, who just narrowly avoids it.

IVAN (CONT'D)

Their world is perfect. Full of abundance. AI's figured everything out. But no, you just couldn't sacrifice your precious little bike lanes.

Eben tries to punch Ivan but he dodges it. He's moving really fast. Ivan throws a counter punch which sends Eben flying.

Eben turns to Jake and Emmett. He points at his laptop.

EBEN

Protect the laptop. It will finish on it's own, just don't let him get to it or he'll shut it down.

Emmett cautiously picks up the laptop.

Eben types into his digital watch and bike wheels appear on his arms, and a bike helmet on his head.

He throws a bike-powered punch at Ivan, which actually manages to stagger him for a second.

EBEN (CONT'D)

Why the bike lanes? What do they have to do with any of this?

Ivan grins.

IVAN

I don't even fully understand it myself. I just know that they're terrified of bikes, and won't touch down in full force where they're plentiful. Something about a resemblance to an ancient god who ruined their world.

EBEN

I thought their world was perfect.

They trade more blows.

IVAN

It is. Now that they've disposed of the cyclist menace.

Ivan grabs Eben and rips the bike wheels off of him.

EBEN

Get out of here!

Ivan impales Eben with his fist. Emmett and Jake flee and hide.

INT. OTHER ROOM - NIGHT

Emmett and Jake crouch down.

JAKE

Fuck what are we going to do?

Ivan is searching for them.

IVAN

You guys have been such good employees. Let's not ruin that streak now.

He's getting closer.

IVAN (CONT'D)

Just hand me that laptop and I'll give you a year's pay right now. Actually, make that three year's pay. All you have to do is give me that laptop.

Emmett looks at the laptop. It's still executing the kill-switch.

JAKE

Fuck man three years pay? That kind of money would change our lives.

EMMETT

But what world would we be spending it in?

JAKE

But our lives suck right now.

EMMETT

Joey sacrificed himself because he believed in a better world. He found the strength to pursue that belief. If we don't have that, then we might as well be dead. Money won't change our lives, but a pursuit of a better world might.

Jake thinks for a second. He sighs.

JAKE

Maybe you're right. But how are we going to stop this guy? He's way too strong and way too fast.

Ivan's even closer.

IVAN

The human soul is limited, help us to rise above it. You will be there at the alter of the new soul's communion, I will make sure of it!

EMMETT

Wait, he's powered by AI right?

JAKE

Yeah, so?

EMMETT

So we can beat him the same way we always beat AI. Just unplug him.

JAKE

Yeah but how are we going to get to his back?

Ivan comes into the room.

EMMETT

Just like in Fortnite man. You lay down cover fire and I'll flank him.

Jake nods.

JAKE

Alright. Let's do it.

He stands up and throws something at Ivan, getting his attention. Emmett sneaks away.

JAKE (CONT'D)

Hey boss, that offer sounds really good but I'm going to have to decline. AI sucks.

Ivan rushes him and grabs him by the throat, lifting him into the air.

IVAN

You idiot. You just fear that your imbecilic utility will vanish once AI becomes pervasive.

JAKE

And you just fear that you'll never
have what we have. A soul. Now!
Unplug him.

Emmett, who has gotten behind Ivan, springs up and rips the
chord out of the back of Ivan's head.

IVAN

Wait, what did you...?

He reaches behind him to feel the unplugged wire.

IVAN (CONT'D)

Oh, no. I can't-

He turns to dust, leaving his empty clothes to fall to the
floor in a heap.

EMMETT

What the hell?

JAKE

Wait, the computer, where is it?

They look around but it's not there. They hear the floor
creak and they both swing around. It's the Alien, holding the
laptop. They chase after him.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

They chase the Alien into the street.

Suddenly it gets hit by a car.

Emmett and Jake just stare, slack-jawed.

The laptop goes flying into the air, and Emmett catches it.

The door of the car opens. Joey, badly wounded, but alive, is
the driver. He steps out, clutching a wound in his side.

JOEY

That's for getting in the way of my
overtime pay.

The injured Alien stands back up. He turns to Jake and
Emmett. Emmett shows it the completed kill switch process
screen.

EMMETT

It's over. You lost.

The Alien shakes it's fist angrily and then hurriedly limps away into the distance. Joey, Jake, and Emmett watch him go.

JAKE

You guys want to play some
Fortnite?

EMMETT

No, no not really.

THE END